

FIELD LIBRARY / ACTION CHECKLIST

Evacuation with access or mobility needs

EVACUATION SHELTER / EDITION 2026-10-02

QUICK ANSWER / START HERE

Plan movement around the person who needs the most assistance. Keep mobility aids, medicines, communication tools and essential care supplies together. Confirm accessible transport and a suitable destination directly; do not assume a shelter, lift or public rescue vehicle will be available.

Do now.

- ☐ **Identify the actual assistance**
01 Write down transfer needs, walking distance, stairs, powered devices, communication needs and care routines. Ask the person what help is safe and useful.
- ☐ **Check the route**
02 Assess exits and stairs before a crisis. Do not use lifts in a fire or damaged building, and do not improvise a dangerous carry.
- ☐ **Confirm support**
03 Arrange more than one trusted helper and transport option. Make the responsibility specific rather than assuming someone else will come.
- ☐ **Keep essential equipment close**
04 Include medicines, charger, batteries, mobility aids and a concise care note. Keep a portable backup where possible.
- ☐ **Verify the destination**
05 Ask about step-free entry, toilets, charging, refrigeration, caregivers and service animals. A general promise of accessibility is not a confirmed arrangement.

Keep the plan moving.

IF HELP IS UNAVAILABLE

Use your confirmed private support network and a destination suited to care needs. If transport cannot be arranged, identify the safest available refuge and communicate the precise assistance required through a safe channel.

Watch for.

Do not separate a person from essential equipment or a necessary caregiver if avoidable. An untrained lifting attempt can injure both the person and the helper.

People & practical needs.

Practice the route using the actual mobility and communication aids. Keep chargers, essential medicines and written instructions together

Next decision.

Practise the plan with the person's consent and revise it when equipment or care needs change. Keep an alternative plan for power loss and an unavailable caregiver.

YOUR SITUATION / PRIVATE WORKSHEET

TIME / LOCATION / CHANGING CONDITIONS

PEOPLE / ACCESS OR MEDICAL NEEDS

SOURCES / SCOPE / LIMITS

Source-linked civilian guidance, not independent clinical or specialist certification. U.S. references; emergency numbers and services differ. Training and product instructions remain essential.

[Ready.gov](#) · [People with disabilities](#)

Full guide: <https://ospreyzero.com/emergencies/accessible-evacuation/>